

KDD ID	Category	Decision Area
REQ-APP-001	Approval Foundation	Approval Governance Model
REQ-APP-002	Approval Routing	Cost Center Approver
REQ-APP-003	Approval Routing	Supervisor Approval
REQ-APP-004	Approval Thresholds	Dollar Thresholds
REQ-APP-005	Approval Thresholds	Cumulative Spend
REQ-APP-006	Approval Routing	Department or Operating Unit Approval
REQ-APP-007	Approval Routing	Category-Based Review
REQ-APP-008	Approval Routing	Funding-Based Approval

REQ-APP-009	Approval Routing	Grant Compliance Approval
REQ-APP-010	Approval Routing	Emergency Procurement
REQ-APP-011	Procurement Review	Buyer Review Requirement
REQ-APP-012	Touchless Procurement	Automatic PO Generation Eligibility
REQ-APP-013	Touchless Procurement	PO Approval After Auto-Generation
REQ-APP-014	Touchless Procurement	PO Transmission
REQ-APP-015	Touchless Procurement	Exception Handling
REQ-APP-016	Governance	External Oversight

REQ-APP-017	Governance	Delegated Authority
REQ-APP-018	Governance	Approval Delegation / Vacation Rules
REQ-APP-019	Compliance	Segregation of Duties
REQ-APP-020	Compliance	Policy Exception Approvals
REQ-APP-021	Budgetary Controls	Budget Check Timing
REQ-APP-022	Budgetary Controls	Insufficient Funds Handling
REQ-APP-023	Approval Routing	Parallel vs Sequential Approval
REQ-APP-024	Approval Routing	FYI Notifications

REQ-APP-025	Approval Routing	Approval Aging / Escalation
REQ-APP-026	Security	Approver Eligibility
REQ-APP-027	Security	Requester Restrictions
REQ-APP-028	Data Requirements	Required Requisition Attributes
REQ-APP-029	Testing	Approval Test Scenarios
REQ-APP-030	Training	Approver and Requester Training

AI Discovery Question	Business Context / Why It Matters
What is the primary governance model for requisition approvals?	Establishes whether approvals are driven by management hierarchy, financial ownership, procurement policy, or specialized control groups.
Should requisitions route to the cost center owner or cost center approver?	Cost center approval is common in SLED because financial accountability may sit with budget owners rather than a requester's supervisor.
Should the requester's supervisor approve requisitions?	Supervisor approvals are easy to understand but may not align with financial ownership in public sector organizations.
Do approval requirements change based on requisition amount?	Thresholds define financial authority and escalation requirements.
Should approvals consider cumulative spend against a supplier, agreement, project, or fiscal period?	Some clients want controls beyond the individual requisition amount.
Do departments or operating units have their own approval rules?	SLED clients often have decentralized departments with unique approval expectations.
Do certain procurement categories require specialized approval?	Categories such as IT, fleet, facilities, legal, or professional services may require specialized review.
Should funding source, fund type, grant, project, or account combination affect approvals?	Funding rules are often a major SLED compliance driver.

Do grant-funded requisitions require additional compliance approval?

Grant-funded purchases often require extra validation for allowability, period of performance, and funding restrictions.

Do emergency purchases follow a separate approval path?

Emergency purchases often require speed but also strong audit controls.

When should procurement manually review requisitions before PO creation?

Buyer intervention determines whether procurement is a control point or a bottleneck.

Which requisitions should automatically generate purchase orders after approval?

Defines touchless procurement strategy and downstream automation.

Should an automatically generated PO require a separate approval?

Determines whether requisition approval is sufficient to commit the organization.

Should approved POs be automatically transmitted to suppliers?

Controls the final step in touchless procurement.

What should happen when a requisition fails auto-PO generation criteria?

Exception handling prevents failed automation from causing process confusion.

Do certain purchases require executive, legislative, governing authority, committee, or external oversight?

SLED clients may have governance requirements that occur outside normal system workflow.

Is there a formal delegation of authority that defines approvers and limits?

Delegation of authority is the backbone for approval configuration.

How should temporary approval delegation be handled?

Approvals must continue when approvers are unavailable.

Can requesters approve their own requisitions?

Segregation of duties is a critical audit control.

How are policy exceptions approved?

Exceptions such as after-the-fact purchases, sole source, or non-standard requests may require additional control.

When should budget validation occur relative to requisition approval?

Budget validation controls whether approval occurs before or after funds are verified.

What should happen when a requisition fails funds validation?

Defines whether budget issues stop or route the transaction.

Should approvals occur sequentially or in parallel?

Approval sequencing affects cycle time and accountability.

Who needs visibility without approval authority?

Some stakeholders need awareness but should not slow approvals.

What should happen if an approval is not completed within a defined time?

Escalation prevents stalled requisitions.

Who is eligible to approve requisitions?

Approver eligibility controls governance and auditability.

Should certain users be restricted from submitting or approving specific requisitions?

User restrictions may be required for policy, grants, departments, or security.

Which requisition attributes are needed to support approval routing?

Approvals often depend on fields that must be captured consistently.

What approval scenarios must be tested before go-live?

Testing confirms that approval design works for real-world transaction variations.

What training is needed based on the approval design?

Training reduces confusion and supports adoption.

Possible Client Responses

- Supervisory hierarchy
 - Position hierarchy
 - Cost center approver
 - Department approver
 - Approval group
 - Always route to cost center approver
 - Route to cost center approver above a threshold
 - Route to department approver instead
 - Route to both supervisor and cost center approver
 - No cost center approval
 - Supervisor approves all requisitions
 - Supervisor approves only above threshold
 - Supervisor receives FYI only
 - Supervisor approval not used
-
- No thresholds
 - Single threshold
 - Multi-tier thresholds
 - Thresholds vary by department
 - Thresholds vary by category
 - Transaction-level only
 - Supplier cumulative spend
 - Agreement cumulative spend
 - Project cumulative spend
 - Fiscal-year cumulative spend
 - Same rules for all departments
 - Department-specific approvers
 - Department-specific thresholds
 - Centralized approval model
-
- IT review
 - Legal review
 - Facilities review
 - Fleet review
 - Safety review
 - Grant-funded transactions require review
 - Capital project purchases require review
 - Certain funds require finance approval
 - Account combinations only validate budget
 - No funding-based routing

- Grant office approves all grant-funded purchases
- Grant office approves above threshold
- Finance validates only
- No separate grant review

- Expedited approval
- Post-approval review
- Executive approval only
- Procurement review required
- Standard workflow applies
- All requisitions
- Non-catalog only
- High-dollar only
- Special categories only
- Exceptions only
- Catalog requisitions
- Contract-backed requisitions
- Approved supplier purchases
- Low-dollar purchases
- Specific categories
- Requisition approval serves as PO approval
- PO auto-approved below threshold
- PO requires procurement approval
- PO requires finance approval
- PO requires supplier/category-specific approval
- Auto-transmit all approved POs
- Auto-transmit only catalog POs
- Procurement reviews before transmit
- Manual transmit only
- Supplier portal only
- Route to buyer
- Return to requester
- Route to procurement queue
- Create incomplete PO
- Hold for review
- Executive review
- Legislative approval
- Governing authority approval
- Procurement committee review
- External agency approval

- Formal written delegation exists
 - Informal delegation exists
 - Department-specific delegation
 - No current delegation matrix
-
- Formal delegation in system
 - Manual reassignment
 - Backup approvers
 - Escalation after aging
 - No delegation process
 - Self-approval prohibited
 - Self-approval allowed below threshold
 - Executive exceptions allowed
 - Emergency exceptions allowed
-
- Procurement approves exceptions
 - Executive approves exceptions
 - Compliance office approves exceptions
 - Exceptions not allowed
 - Exception reason only
 - Validate before submission
 - Validate during approval
 - Validate before PO creation
 - Warning only
 - No budget validation
 - Hard stop
 - Warning only
 - Route to budget office
 - Route to cost center owner
 - Allow override with justification
 - Sequential only
 - Parallel finance and procurement review
 - Parallel specialist reviews
 - Mixed sequencing
-
- Department head FYI
 - Procurement FYI
 - Finance FYI
 - Grant office FYI
 - No FYI notifications

- Reminder notification
- Escalate to backup approver
- Reassign to supervisor
- Procurement admin intervention
- No escalation
- Managers only
- Cost center owners
- Named approval groups
- Role-based approvers
- Buyer approvers
- Restrict by department
- Restrict by category
- Restrict by funding source
- Restrict approval only
- No restrictions
- Category
- Cost center
- Fund
- Project
- Grant
- Low-dollar catalog
- High-dollar non-catalog
- Grant-funded
- Emergency
- Cost center approval
- Requester training
- Approver training
- Buyer training
- Finance approver training
- Workflow admin training

AI Interpretation Logic	FSM-First Design Guidance
AI should identify the dominant approval pattern before asking detailed threshold or exception questions.	Use FSM approval rules when routing can be expressed through clear approval stages, conditions, and approver groups.
AI should determine if cost ownership is the key routing driver and whether cost center approval replaces or supplements hierarchy approval.	Use FSM if cost center approver mapping is straightforward and maintained as part of approval governance.
AI should determine whether supervisor approval is a true control or only a visibility requirement.	Use FSM for basic supervisory routing.
AI should identify whether threshold logic is simple, layered, or multi-dimensional.	Use FSM for clear single-dimension threshold routing.
AI should flag cumulative logic as potentially complex and requiring careful design.	FSM may support simple transaction-level thresholds.
AI should determine whether variation is legitimate policy or historical preference.	Use FSM when departmental differences are limited and cleanly structured.
AI should map specialized approvals to category governance.	Use FSM when category routing is based on stable category values.
AI should determine whether funding is a routing condition, validation rule, or reporting requirement.	Use FSM for simple account or fund conditions where available.

AI should identify whether grant approval is a mandatory control or advisory review.

Use FSM if grant-funded condition is clearly identifiable.

AI should determine who can mark a transaction as emergency and what approvals are bypassed.

Use FSM if emergency flag drives a simple alternate routing.

AI should identify where buyer review adds value and where touchless procurement is appropriate.

Use FSM for clear buyer-review conditions.

AI should determine which transactions are low-risk enough for automation.

FSM should handle the approval decision before auto-generation. Avoid BPM unless routing is complex.

AI should identify duplicate approval layers and determine whether PO approval adds meaningful control.

Use FSM to define simple PO approval rules.

AI should determine whether approval, creation, and transmission are fully touchless or partially touchless.

Use standard purchasing setup where transmission rules are straightforward.

AI should define the fallback path for non-touchless transactions.

FSM can route exceptions to buyer review.

AI should determine whether oversight is internal, external, pre-award, pre-PO, or informational only.

FSM may support additional stages or FYI notifications if the approval is simple.

AI should determine whether configuration can be built from policy or whether policy rationalization is needed first.	FSM works best when delegated authority is clearly documented.
---	--

AI should identify whether delegation is managed by user preference, workflow admin, or governance process.	Use standard delegation and reassignment functionality where possible.
---	--

AI should identify whether self-approval is prohibited absolutely or conditionally.	Use FSM rules to prevent or route around self-approval where supported.
---	---

AI should identify whether exception approvals are routed through requisition workflow or a separate process.	FSM may support simple exception attributes and approval conditions.
---	--

AI should separate budget validation from approval routing.	FSM approval logic should not replace budgetary control setup.
---	--

AI should identify whether failed funds validation is a system stop, approval path, or exception process.	Use standard budgetary control where possible.
---	--

AI should determine which approvals are dependent and which can occur independently.	FSM can support straightforward stage sequencing.
--	---

AI should distinguish required approval from informational visibility.	Use FYI notifications instead of approvals when no decision is required.
--	--

AI should identify escalation expectations and ownership.

Use standard workflow reminders and reassignment where possible.

AI should determine whether approvers are derived from hierarchy, roles, or maintained approval groups.

FSM works best with clean approver sources and maintained approval groups.

AI should determine whether restriction belongs in security, approval routing, or procurement policy.

Use security and role design first where possible.

AI should identify missing fields needed for routing logic.

Use standard attributes first and avoid unnecessary DFFs.

AI should convert design decisions into test scenarios.

FSM configuration should be validated with realistic transactions.

AI should identify training impacts from the approval design.

Keep process simple to reduce training burden.

When BPM May Be Needed	Recommended Oracle Capability
Use BPM if routing requires nested logic, complex sequencing, custom expressions, or combinations of many attributes.	FSM Approval Rules / BPM for complex routing
Use BPM if cost center routing must vary by funding source, category, project, grant, or complex exception rules.	FSM Approval Rules
Use BPM only if supervisor approval has complex skip logic or conditional routing.	FSM Supervisory Approval
Use BPM when thresholds combine amount, category, department, fund, supplier type, and emergency status.	FSM Amount-Based Approval Rules
BPM or custom reporting controls may be needed for cumulative or look-back logic.	BPM / Reporting Controls
Use BPM if department logic combines with multiple other routing dimensions.	FSM Department-Based Rules
Use BPM if category routing depends on additional attributes such as amount, funding, supplier, or project.	FSM Category Conditions
Use BPM if funding logic is multi-dimensional or requires integration with Projects/Grants.	FSM Account-Based Rules / BPM if complex

Use BPM if grant approval depends on grant type, award period, sponsor, cost category, or exception handling. FSM / BPM for complex grant logic

Use BPM if emergency routing creates conditional bypasses, retrospective approvals, or special notifications. FSM Conditional Approval Rules

Use BPM if buyer review has complex conditional sequencing or exception handling. FSM Approval Rules

BPM may be needed if auto-PO eligibility depends on many layered approval conditions. Auto PO Generation / Document Builder

Use BPM if PO approvals diverge significantly from requisition approvals. FSM PO Approval Rules

Use BPM only if transmission requires complex holds or exception approvals. PO Communication / Supplier Portal

BPM may be needed if exception handling requires multiple conditional paths. Exception Routing Rules

BPM or manual tracking may be needed if system must wait for external actions. Approval Stage / Tracking Attribute

BPM cannot fix unclear governance. Escalate if authority is not defined.

Approval Matrix

BPM may be needed for complex escalation patterns.

Delegation / Reassignment

Use BPM if SOD rules require complex exception handling.

Approval Restrictions

BPM may be needed for multiple exception types and specialized paths.

Exception Approval Rules

BPM should not be used as a substitute for proper budget controls.

Budgetary Control

BPM may be needed only if budget failure triggers unique approval routing.

Budgetary Control / Approval Routing

BPM may be needed for advanced branching and parallel routing complexity.

Approval Stages

BPM rarely needed for simple FYI notifications.

FYI Notification Rules

BPM may be needed for complex escalation hierarchy.

Workflow Escalation

BPM may be required for custom approver derivation.

Approval Groups / Roles

Avoid using BPM to compensate for poor role design unless necessary.

Security Roles / Approval Rules

BPM or extensions may be needed if required attributes are not available in approval rules.

Requisition Fields / DFFs

Complex BPM requires more exhaustive scenario testing.

Approval Testing Scripts

Complex BPM-driven designs require deeper admin and support training.

Training Materials

Primary Configuration Object	Dependencies / Cross-Functional Impact
Requisition Approval Rules	HR hierarchy, financial ownership, security roles, procurement policy
Cost Center Approval Mapping	Finance ownership data, chart of accounts, department governance
Approval Hierarchy	HR supervisor hierarchy, user assignments
Approval Conditions	Finance policy, procurement policy, delegated authority matrix
Approval Rules, Spend Reports	Supplier spend data, agreements, budget controls
Approval Conditions, Approval Groups	Department hierarchy, financial ownership
Category-Based Approval Rules	Category hierarchy, procurement policy, specialist approvers
Charge Account Conditions, Funding Validation	ERP, Grants, Projects, Budgetary Control

Grant Approval Rules	Grants team, Projects, Budgetary Control
Emergency Attribute, Approval Conditions	Procurement policy, audit requirements, requester controls
Buyer Review Rules	Procurement staffing, catalog strategy, supplier governance
Auto Create Rules, Document Styles	Supplier setup, agreements, catalog controls, buyer assignment
PO Approval Conditions	Purchasing policy, financial controls, supplier risk
Supplier Site Communication Method	Supplier setup, communication method, document style
Buyer Assignment Rules	Procurement operations, requester communication
Approval Groups, Requisition DFF	Governance calendars, public meeting schedules, legal requirements

Delegation of Authority	Finance, procurement leadership, legal or policy owners
Workflow Delegation	Security, workflow admin, approver training
Requester / Approver Conditions	Security roles, audit policy
Requisition Attributes, Approval Conditions	Procurement policy, compliance review
Budget Validation Rules	ERP finance setup, control budgets
Control Budget Rules, Approval Conditions	Finance, budget office, procurement
Approval Rule Sequencing	Approver accountability, process timing
Workflow Notifications	Stakeholder communication

Reminder and Escalation Rules

Workflow admin, approver training

User Roles, Approval Groups

Security, HR, finance ownership

User Roles, Data Access, Approval
Conditions

Security, finance, procurement policy

Requisition Header/Line Attributes

Data governance, requester experience,
reporting

Test Scenarios

Testing team, business owners, procurement
operations

Role-Based Training Guides

Change management, help desk, project team

Potential Risks	Leading Practice Guidance
A poorly defined governance model causes inconsistent approvals and high maintenance.	Start with the simplest approval structure that satisfies policy and audit requirements.
Incorrect or outdated cost center ownership can stall approvals.	Maintain a governed ownership matrix and avoid duplicating supervisor approvals unless required.
Weak HR hierarchy data can cause approval failures.	Use supervisor approval only where it adds meaningful governance.
Overlapping thresholds create routing conflicts.	Normalize approval thresholds before configuring workflow.
Trying to force cumulative controls into simple approvals can create unreliable governance.	Use transaction-level controls in workflow and monitor cumulative exposure through reporting where practical.
Too much departmental variation undermines standardization.	Challenge unnecessary department-level exceptions.
Poor category maintenance breaks routing.	Use category approval only for true control points.
Weak funding controls can create audit findings.	Separate validation requirements from approval routing requirements.

Invalid grant purchases may create compliance exposure.	Automate grant validation where possible, but avoid unnecessary review of low-risk transactions.
---	--

Emergency paths may be abused without justification controls.	Require justification and audit trail for emergency purchases.
---	--

Over-reviewing routine purchases slows the process.	Reserve buyer review for higher-risk or non-standard purchases.
---	---

Auto-generation without governance can bypass procurement controls.	Use touchless procurement for repeatable, policy-compliant purchases.
---	---

Duplicate approvals add cycle time without improving control.	Where requisition approval is robust, avoid repeating the same approval on the PO.
---	--

Incorrect auto-transmission may send inaccurate POs.	Auto-transmit only when supplier, pricing, and approval controls are reliable.
--	--

Unclear exceptions create stuck transactions.	Define a clear exception owner and action path.
---	---

If external approval is not tracked, audit evidence may be incomplete.	Capture approval reference, date, and authority where possible.
--	---

Configuring unclear authority creates rework and disputes.

Require approval authority clarity before build.

Unavailable approvers can create process delays.

Use standard delegation functionality and clear backup ownership.

Self-approval can create audit exposure.

Avoid self-approval except in clearly documented exceptions.

Weak exception governance can normalize non-compliance.

Require reason codes and targeted review.

Approving unfunded requisitions creates downstream failures.

Validate funding before final commitment where practical.

Allowing unfunded transactions can create compliance issues.

Use hard stops for formal budget controls unless policy allows override.

Poorly designed parallel approvals may confuse ownership.

Use parallel approvals only when reviews are independent.

Too many FYIs create notification fatigue.

Use FYI only when there is a business need.

Stalled approvals delay procurement and reduce trust in the system.

Implement reminders before complex escalation.

Incorrect approver eligibility creates audit issues.

Use role-based or ownership-based approver sources with clear governance.

Misplaced controls increase complexity.

Put access controls in security and approval controls in workflow.

Missing or inconsistent data breaks automated routing.

Capture only data needed for process, compliance, or reporting.

Insufficient testing causes approval failures at go-live.

Test standard, exception, and edge-case scenarios.

Poor training creates support burden and workarounds.

Train by role and scenario, not just by module.

Standard or Variance	Output Asset Trigger	Notes
Standard	Approval Matrix Workbook	
Standard	Cost Center Approval Matrix	
Standard	Approval Matrix Workbook	
Standard	Delegation of Authority Matrix	
Variance	Complex Workflow Requirements Workbook	
Standard	Approval Matrix Workbook	
Standard	Category Approval Matrix	
Variance	Funding Approval Matrix	

Variance	Grant Approval Matrix
Variance	Emergency Approval Scenario
Standard	Buyer Review Matrix
Standard	Auto PO Eligibility Matrix
Standard	PO Approval Strategy Matrix
Standard	PO Transmission Matrix
Standard	Exception Handling Matrix
Variance	External Governance Tracking Matrix

Standard	Delegation of Authority Matrix
----------	--------------------------------

Standard	Delegation Process Design
----------	---------------------------

Standard	SOD Approval Matrix
----------	---------------------

Variance	Policy Exception Matrix
----------	-------------------------

Standard	Budget Control Decision Matrix
----------	--------------------------------

Standard	Funds Failure Handling Matrix
----------	-------------------------------

Standard	Approval Sequencing Matrix
----------	----------------------------

Standard	Notification Matrix
----------	---------------------

Standard	Escalation Matrix
Standard	Approver Eligibility Matrix
Variance	Security and Approval Control Matrix
Standard	Approval Data Requirements Matrix
Standard	Approval Test Script Pack
Standard	Approval Training Matrix